

Figure 2.13 Geometrical representation of parallel vectors

(ii) Anti–parallel vectors: Two vectors $\vec{A}$ and $\vec{B}$ are said to be anti–parallel when they are in opposite directions along the same line or on parallel lines. Then the angle between them is 180^0 (Figure 2.14).

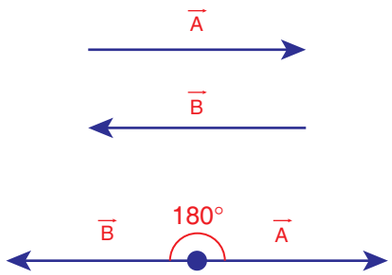


Figure 2.14 Geometrical representation of anti–parallel vectors.

2. **Unit vector**: A vector divided by its magnitude is a unit vector. The unit vector for $\vec{A}$ is denoted by $\hat{A}$ (read as A cap or A hat). It has a magnitude equal to unity or one.

$$\text{Since, } \hat{A} = \frac{\vec{A}}{A} \text{ we can write } \vec{A} = A\hat{A}$$

Thus, we can say that the unit vector specifies only the direction of the vector quantity.

3. **Orthogonal unit vectors**: Let $\hat{i}, \hat{j}$ *and* $\hat{k}$ be three unit vectors which specify the directions along positive x–axis, positive y–axis and positive z–axis respectively. These three unit vectors are directed perpendicular to each other, the angle between any two of them is 90°. $\hat{i}, \hat{j}$ and $\hat{k}$ are examples of orthogonal vectors. Two vectors which are perpendicular to each other are called orthogonal vectors as is shown in the Figure 2.15

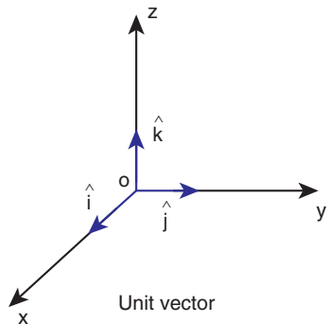


Figure 2.15 Orthogonal unit vectors

2.3.3 Addition of Vectors

Since vectors have both magnitude and direction they cannot be added by the method of ordinary algebra. Thus, vectors can be added geometrically or analytically using certain rules called 'vector algebra'. In order to find the sum (resultant) of two vectors, which are inclined to each other, we use (i) Triangular law of addition method or (ii) Parallelogram law of vectors.

Triangular Law of addition method

Let us consider two vectors $\vec{A}$ and $\vec{B}$ as shown in Figure 2.16.

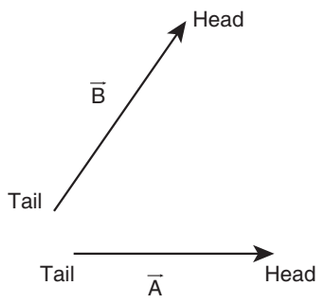


Figure 2.16 Head and tail of vectors

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